

ut Us" statement and begin your nurture effort. Topics on the microsite include GitOps, DevOps, DevSecOps, Ultimate Upgrade and Automated Software delivery. GitLab creates and maintains these SEO-friendly, co-branded microsite, with customized URLs for Partners to use to directly with customers.

Learn more by going to the Marketing Demand Generation section of the Partner Portal.

Customer Case Studies

Testimonials from happy customers are a great tool, but gathering this information can be difficult and time-consuming. To participate in this program, Partners should contact Partner Marketing or learn more by going to the Marketing Demand Generation section of the Partner Portal.

Marketing Development Funds

Select Partners may be eligible for Marketing Development Funds, or MDF, to acquire new GitLab customers, drive demand within an existing mutual customer base, or help educate GitLab teams. GitLab MDF can support multiple marketing efforts, including participation in trade shows, sales incentives, direct mailing costs, training, and more.

Requesting Marketing Development Funds

Our Select Partners are eligible to submit requests for consideration for marketing development funds (MDF). To learn more, check out our MDF handbook page or login to the Partner Portal and visit the marketing page.

GitLab Branded Item Requests

Please submit your request for GitLab-branded items through your Channel Account Manager (CAM). We have been known to co-fund co-branded or locally produced swag.

GitLab Partner Communications and Resources

GitLab uses the Partner Portal, and our News on Demand Platform to communicate with Partners. Partners will automatically receive the newsletter and other communications when they have access to the portal. GitLab will deliver communications in the following manner.

- Partner Flash Newsletter - Once in the portal, navigate to My News to set preferences. A Partner can elect to receive the newsletter daily, weekly, or bi-weekly and select what content type to receive. Example: Only interested in Marketing content? You can opt out of Technical content.
- Partner Webcasts - At times, Channel Programs or Channel Leadership might host a Partner webcast to announce a program change or essential updates. Channel Marketing hosts a monthly Marketing Webcast; other Channel facing teams might elect to host a Webcast for our Partners.
- Partner Portal Notifications - This is not a primary form of communication; it augments other communication vehicles. Partners can see notifications at the top right corner of the portal. Click the bell image within the portal to see active notifications.

- Notifications via email - Occasionally, we will use email notifications to communicate out-of-cycle announcements, send surveys, or Partner SKO/Summit notifications.
- Not receiving communications? Typically a person has opted out. Contact the Partner Help Desk, and we can add you back in. Partners can access archived articles by accessing My News in the portal menu.
- The GitLab Handbook - The GitLab Handbook is the central repository for how we run the company. As part of our value of being transparent, our Handbook is open to the world, and we welcome feedback. Although the Partner Portal is your first source of Partner information, we often link to the Handbook for detailed information. If you are unable to find information you need on the Partner Portal, you are encouraged to search pages of the GitLab Handbook.

More Channel Partner Program Information

If you are looking for additional information on the GitLab Partner program see the following handbook pages.

- Channel Partner Program Overview
- Channel Program Guide
- Channel Services Program
- Channel Services Catalog
- Channel Partner Training and Certifications
- Channel Partners: Working with GitLab
- Channel Tools and Resources
- Alliance Program

Contact Us

All authorized GitLab resellers are invited to the GitLab resellers Slack channel. This Slack channel allows you to reach out to our sales and marketing team in a timely manner, as well as other resellers. Additionally, you can reach the GitLab Channel Team at partnersupport@gitlab.com and the GitLab Partner Marketing Team at partner-marketing@gitlab.com.

SECTION: resellers/training.md

Our role-based training starts with foundational skills and continues with ongoing development to help partners build expertise and validate their GitLab capabilities. The Partner Enablement strategy provides for a structured program in support of partner success when engaging with customers.

We offer tailored training materials and learning paths for multiple roles in your organization including:

- Sales accreditations
- Pre-sales technical accreditations
- Technical consulting services certifications

- Recommended training

These resources empower your team to effectively sell, market and deliver GitLab solutions to customers. Please visit the GitLab University Partner Center via the Partner Portal for more information regarding recommended and required training opportunities.

Benefits of GitLab Accreditations

GitLab is dedicated to empowering our partners with essential skills needed to support both existing and prospective customers.

- Demonstrated Expertise: Accreditations validate that partners possess the knowledge and skills necessary to effectively represent GitLab solutions, establishing credibility with customers.
- Competitive Advantage: Partners with accredited team members stand out in the marketplace, showcasing their commitment to excellence and specialized GitLab knowledge.
- Customer Confidence: Customers gain confidence working with accredited partners who have proven their proficiency in GitLab's tools and methodologies.
- Streamlined Implementation: Accredited partners can implement GitLab solutions more efficiently, reducing deployment time and ensuring best practices are followed.

By investing in GitLab accreditations, partners demonstrate their dedication to providing exceptional service while building the technical foundation necessary for successful customer relationships and implementations.

GitLab has a commitment to enabling our partners with the skills that they need to best support current and future GitLab customers. This includes offering a combination of GitLab Partner Accreditations for Sales, Pre-Sales Technical, and Customer Success roles, as well as offering GitLab Certifications.

GitLab Partner Program Required Training

The GitLab Partner Program required training provides essential knowledge and skills necessary for all GitLab partners. This structured curriculum ensures partners meet standardized proficiency levels to effectively represent, implement, and support GitLab solutions.

This comprehensive training covers:

- Core GitLab platform fundamentals and architecture
- GitLab's Integrated AI assistant-GitLab Duo
- DevSecOps methodology and implementation best practices
- Security and compliance features and frameworks
- GitLab deployment, integration, and migration strategies
- Sales methodologies and value proposition articulation

For Channel Partners

To sign up for any of the courses listed on this page, please visit the GitLab University Partner Center via the Partner Portal for more information regarding recommended and required training opportunities.

For Alliance Partners

Badge Award Process

GitLab uses Credly to award our Technical Certifications and Accreditations. Once you have successfully completed all components of an Accreditation or Certification, you will receive an email notification from Credly. You will need to accept the badge. Once you accept the badge, you will be able to share your badge, attach your badge to your email, and attach your badge to your LinkedIn profile. Please note that it can take 7-10 business days for your completion to be reflected in the partner portal. Please refer to the below links to assist you in managing your badge(s):

- Accepting a Credly badge
- Sharing your Credly badge
- Attach your Credly badge to your email signature
- How to add your Credly badge to your LinkedIn profile
- How to add a secondary email address to your Credly profile

Additional Enablement Resources

- The GitLab Partner Portal - provides Partners with easy access to additional sales resources, webcast replays, competitive analysis, event calendar, Marketing campaigns, support and more.
- Newsletter - sign up here
- GitLab Handbook - start your Handbook search on the Channel Partner Handbook Page

SECTION: resellers/channel-program-guide/_index.md

We invite organizations interested in becoming a GitLab Channel Partner to APPLY NOW.

GitLab Channel Partner Program & Guide

How the Program Works

Partner Program Tracks & Designations

The GitLab Partner Program consists of three tracks and one designation to support the different ways our partners go to market:

Tracks

- Open · This track is for partners (resellers, integrators, sales, and services) in the DevDecOps space , IT as a service (ITaaS) and other adjacent spaces that are committed to investing in their DevSecOps practice. GitLab Open partners may or may not be transacting partners, and qualifying partners can earn product discounts and/or referral fees.
- Select · In this track, partners make a greater investment developing significant sales and services practices, and are expected to drive GitLab customer adoption and expansion. In return, Select partners have a dedicated partner manager and greater sales engagement with GitLab. The Select track is by invitation only.

- Select Services · In this track, partners make a greater investment developing significant services practices with a focus on driving GitLab customer adoption and expansion. In return, Select Services partners have a dedicated partner manager and greater services engagement with GitLab. The Select Services track is by invitation only.

Designations

- Professional Services Partner (PSP) - this partner designation is awarded to partners who deliver service engagements to customers. The service engagements are focused on helping GitLab customers plan, implement, and optimize DevSecOps practices and solutions.

GitLab Open and Select Partner Requirements & Benefits

	Open	Open	Open	Open
Select (Invitation only)	Select Services (Invitation Only)			
Overall Program Requirements				
GitLab Partner Agreement				X
X	X			
\ of Accredited Sales Professional or existing Verified Sales Associate resources				2
4	4			
\ of Solutions Architect Verified Associates				1
2	2			
\ of GitLab Professional Services Engineer (PSE)				
1	3			
Exec Sponsored Joint Business Plan				
X				
Business Plan Commitments				
\$300K	PSP			
Sales Benefits				
Deal Registration Discounts				X
X	X			
Referral Fee				X
X	X			
Renewals Discounts				X

X	X		
Discounts for Reselling GitLab Professional Services			X
X	X		
Support Benefits			
Partner Help desk			X
X	X		
Level 2 Support Hotline			
X	X		
Dedicated Partner Manager			
X	X		
Not for Resale Licenses			X
X	X		
Practice Development Benefits			
Partner Portal			X
X	X		
Proposal Based MDF			
X	X		
Sales & Pre-Sales Technical Enablement			X
X	X		
Program Logo			X
X	X		
Program & Certification Badges			X
X	X		
GitLab.com Listing			X
X (featured)	X (featured)		

Services Practice Benefits	
Rebates for Attaching Your Services to GitLab Sales PSPs) X	X (for
	X
Professional Services Designations, Training, Accreditations, & Certifications	X
X	X
Authorized Managed Services Benefits	
Managed Services Discount	X
X	X

GitLab Incentives Guide

GitLab maintains our incentives in our GitLab Incentive Guide. To access the guide you must have access to our partner portal which you can do if your organization is an authorized GitLab partner by submitting your work email corresponding to your organizational URL through this link and following the instructions you receive to set up your portal account.

GitLab Select Services Track

With a launch in August 2024, the Select Services Track is designed to allow GitLab to engage closely with organizations whose primary business model is services. The Select Services Track is designed around the GitLab Partner Services Program, with a key requirement being that Select Services partners must be Designated GitLab Professional Services Partners (PSP) fulfilling all requirements of the designation. This is an invitation only program which will require a joint business plan focussing on a partner's services practice and capabilities. If you are interested in being invited to join the track, your best chance of success is to have built a mature services practice around the GitLab PSP which is open to all authorized partners.

You might note that another requirement of the track is having accredited Sales Professionals on staff. This is in acknowledgement of how consultative GitLab services engagements are and the Sales Professional accreditation is a powerful foundation for your engineers and consultants to help in those engagements.

GitLab Partner Services Program

The GitLab Partner Services program is designed to help new or existing partners design service portfolios around the DevSecOps Lifecycle in correlation to GitLab products. The program helps partners evaluate business opportunities and creates a technical enablement framework to use as they build their GitLab-related service practices.

The foundation of the GitLab Partner Services Program is the GitLab Professional Services Partner Designation (PSP).

Becoming a Designated GitLab Professional Services Partner (PSP)

GitLab Professional Services Partner Designation (PSP) has partner program, competency, and delivery requirements that must be completed before you can obtain the designation. PSP designations will be awarded to partners who complete the requirements below.

GitLab PSP Designation Requirements

Program Entry Requirements

Each PSP must be:

1. An authorized GitLab partner
2. Design, build and operate a professional service practice, and
3. Meet the Delivery Requirements, and
4. Hire team members who have completed the competency requirements and/or sponsor the appropriate number of team members through the completion of the competency requirements.

Competency Requirements

- Each PSP must perpetually employ at least three (3) GitLab Certified Professional Service Engineers.

Delivery Requirements

- Each PSP must complete an average of at least 2 service engagements per GitLab Fiscal Quarter. Note, the GitLab fiscal year starts on February 1 of each year.
- Starting in Q3 FY25 (August 1, 2024), the following qualify as proof of completed service engagements:
 1. Service Attach Registrations
 1. Managed Services Provider deal registrations
- When partners who have completed the competency requirements also complete their first two service attach registrations in a single GitLab Fiscal Quarter, they will receive their PSP designation within 7 business days.
- Each PSP will be required to have submitted at least 8 Service Attach Registrations over the previous 12 months at their annual audit(s). If during the previous 12 months, the partner was engaged in a longer-term, multi-phase project, some of the 8 registrations may be for different phases of the same service engagement.

GitLab PSP Designation Information

- The GitLab Partner team will communicate new PSP designations through email and will reflect the designation in the GitLab Partner Locator.
- Partners who received their PSP designation prior to Nov. 2023 will have until their next annual audit to become compliant with the new criteria.

- The annual audits are performed quarterly, and will begin during Q1FY25 (Feb. 2024-Apr. 2024).
- Service delivery requirement will be prorated for the period between Nov. 2023-Nov. 2024.

Maintaining PSP Designation

GitLab Partner program will review the service attach registrations and the practitioner certification statuses of each GitLab Professional Service Partner each year in the quarter the partner was originally granted certification. Partners at risk for non-compliance will receive an audit warning email 30 days prior to their removal of their PSP designation. This will allow partners and their account managers time to create a plan to return to compliance.

- If partners become compliant during the 30-day warning period, they will not have their PSP designation removed.
- If partners remain ineligible after the 30-day warning period, their PSP designation will be removed, their PSP badge will no longer be shown on the partner locator, and they will be notified through email. Partners are encouraged to work with their GitLab Ecosystem Sales Manager (ESM) to create a plan for obtaining and maintaining designation. When a partner regains PSP eligibility, their badge will be re-issued within 7 business days.

Contact Us

You can email the GitLab Partner Support Team at partnersupport@gitlab.com

SECTION: resellers/channel-program-guide/mdf.md

MDF Program Introduction

GitLab Open and Select partners have access to the proposal-based GitLab Marketing Development Funds (MDF) Program. These funds are intended to support our partners' demand generation efforts.

MDF Investment Objectives

Demand Generation

- The objective of these activities is to gain net-new end-user customers for you and GitLab. Examples of eligible activities include seminars, workshops, telemarketing or email marketing campaigns, participation in tradeshow, exhibitions, and direct mail.
- Eligible costs may include mailing costs, fulfillment items, lead qualification, distribution, venue costs, food and beverages (excluding alcoholic beverages), speakers' fees, management costs, and lead capturing costs.
- GitLab supports a limited number of partners in the selected regions, please check your eligibility with your regional Channel Account Manager and Channel Marketing Manager

To be considered for funding support you must

- Be a Marketing Ready Select or Open GitLab Partner. Marketing ready means: partner has an

approved business plan with GitLab; has a list of focus accounts mapped with GitLab; has a dedicated person who manages leads sent to the partner by GitLab (Partner Prospect Admin); acknowledges the lead passing and recall process; has a dedicated marketing responsible person to work on the joint activities with GitLab; has regular calls with the GitLab Channel Marketing Manager; acknowledges the MDF Policy and requirements for MDF process (Requests and Claims)

- Comply with GitLab Proof of Performance (POP) requirements for the activity
- Meet minimum required MDF request amount of \$1,000 USD
- GitLab will cover up to 50% of the total cost of the activity

Eligible Activities and Required Proof of Performance MDF Activities

Proof of performance (POP) includes partner-generated invoice AND at least one of the activities listed in the table below that shows GitLab and partner representation. For activities that require a lead list, you must also submit it in an spreadsheet excel format, as part of your POP.

Eligible Activity	Description	Proof of Performance
	Collateral Sales Tools	Printed or web-based material developed to assist in your efforts to promote GitLab solutions (product briefs, data sheets, case studies, etc.). The document must include the GitLab logo.
		- Electronic version or hard copy of marketing collateral - Graphic files or digital photos that show the integration of GitLab brand/solutions - eDM/Direct mail
	Events	Any industry or partner event that you plan to attend to promote or host GitLab solutions. This can be done in collaboration with other vendors that don't compete with GitLab. Events may also include enablement activities.
		(REQUIRED) Lead list/Attendee list (to include: Company Name, Contact, Title, Email, & Phone. Please use MDF Lead List template) - Electronic version or hard copy of invitation - Marketing collateral - Photo of display/booth/event - Funded Head (Distribution Only)
	Partner Sponsorship	Participation in a partner-led event or activity or third-party event.
		- Contract of signed sponsorship - Lead list (to include Company Name, Contact, Title, Email, & Phone. Please use MDF Lead List template)
	Marketing Materials	The delivery of co-branded marketing materials (digital or physical) to promote GitLab solutions. Eligible assets include emails, direct mailers and social media posts, and must include the GitLab logo.
		- Electronic version or hard copy sample of direct mail, newsletter - Lead list (to include Company Name, Contact, Title, Email, & Phone. Please use MDF Lead List template)
	Lead Generation/ Telemarketing	Delivery of co-branded messages via telephone or other mediums to gain net-new customers. The message should focus on GitLab solutions. The contact list should include Company Name, First Name, Last Name, Title, Email, Phone.
		(REQUIRED) Lead list or call list (to include: Company Name, Contact, Title, Email, & Phone. Please use MDF Lead List template) - Telemarketing script of how GitLab brand or solution were incorporated into the campaign - Itemized call record or campaign metrics - Internal invoice accepted
	Webcast/Webinar	A syndicated or on-demand web event with the purpose of either lead generation or continuing education. This can be conducted in collaboration with GitLab or GitLab-approved third-party vendors.
		(REQUIRED) Lead list/Attendee list (to include: Company Name, Contact, Title, Email, & Phone. Please use MDF Lead List template) - URL to recorded online event, podcast, or presentation that shows integration of GitLab brand and

solutions
 · Invitation to the online event/podcast
 · Follow up/additional activities

|

| Demand Gen focused joint planning session | A joint meeting between GitLab & Partner where the output is a demand generation activity. This should NOT be a GitLab 101 or 201 training, as that is handled by our enablement team. A detailed agenda for session must be provided at MDF request submission stage. | · (REQUIRED) Date of demand generation activity & targeted lead list of who received an outbound motion. (to include: Company Name, Contact, Title, Email. Please use MDF Lead List template|

MDF Process

To obtain marketing development funds (MDF), please complete the following steps prior to any activity being performed or expense incurred. Any activity that does not follow the process below and has the appropriate approvals will not be eligible for reimbursement.

MDF Request

- Partners can access the MDF Request Form from the GitLab Partner Portal home page. Navigate to Marketing and select "MDF Request." Upon selecting MDF Request, complete the first part of the form to create a fund request. Once completed, click "submit it".
- Please check this how-to video on how to submit an MDF Fund Request.
- All MDF requests should be submitted at least 10 business days prior to the activity start date
- You should have a marketing plan in place by working with your designated Channel Marketing Manager & Channel Account Manager and all MDF activities should be agreed to prior to submitting the request form in the portal.
- Our goal is to have the approval (or rejection) of your MDF request back to the partner within 5 business days.
- As our program is proposal based, GitLab does not guarantee every partner will receive MDF.

MDF Approval

- After submission of the MDF request, your GitLab Channel Marketing Manager will review and approve or deny the request.
- You will be notified via email.
- You must get formal approval before proceeding with your activity.

Timeframe for Completing Activity

- Partners must complete the activity within the quarter that the request has been approved for. If at any point within the funding quarter you decide the allocated funds will not be used for the approved activity, you must notify your Channel Marketing Manager.

Canceling and Reallocating Funds for an Activity

If the originally approved activity will not take place, please notify your GitLab Channel Marketing Manager. You may be able to reallocate your funds to another activity that is equal to or less than the original approved activity that takes place within the same time frame, but this must be approved by your Channel Marketing Manager.

Receiving leads post MDF activity

If your MDF activity has a lead list, as required by our POP policy, you must include a copy of the joint event lead list. This list is considered confidential and the property of both GitLab and the authorized GitLab partner, and will be used for the sole purpose of tracking lead progress and calculating the activities return on investment. By submitting your MDF request, you agree to these terms and conditions.

Upon your submission of the lead list, GitLab will pass those leads back to you directly within the GitLab Partner portal, making it seamless to connect your deals you'd like to deal reg back to the MDF request.

Instructions on how to accept/reject/reassign a lead or register a deal and submit to GitLab for approval can be found via this video or in the partner portal.

Funds reimbursement Requirements

- Submission of a payment claim (invoice) within 30 calendar days of completion of the activity via the MDF Reimbursement Request form on the GitLab Partner Portal.
- Supporting documentation based on the activity, documented here
AND

- Invoice
 - Invoice will be accepted from the Partner only
 - It must clearly state the MDF activity name in the description
 - Have an invoice number
 - Made payable to GitLab Inc.

For partners who are claiming reimbursement for the first time only:

- A 5 day exception is added to the 30 days, giving partners a total of 35 days, from the activity end date, to submit their claim. This is in place in order to accommodate Partner's onboarding process in GitLab's procurement system, Coupa.
- GitLab may reach out once to partner, but if no response is received and the 30 or 35 days has commenced, the activity will be canceled and no payment will be made thereafter.
- GitLab is not responsible for reimbursing partners that submit a request after this 30 days or 35 days for new partners has passed.

MDF Terms and Conditions

- Marketing development funds (MDFs) may not be used for capital expenses or the normal cost of business.
- Activities/expenses NOT covered under the GitLab MDF Program include alcohol, cash, charity events/activities, product discounts, travel, and lodging expenses.
- Activities that involve multiple vendors will not be supported at 100% funding by GitLab. The local Channel Marketing Manager may approve a percentage of funding based on the number of vendors and visibility of GitLab versus other participating vendors.
- GitLab reserves the right to modify or terminate the MDF Program upon 30-days advance written notice, which is provided on the GitLab Partner Portal. Such modification or termination will not affect prior approved requests for activities that ran before the effective date of the modification or termination, nor will it affect prior approved plans in progress at the time of

the change.

- If claims are not submitted within 30 calendar days following the activity, the funding allotment and/or allocation may be null and void, and you may forfeit any unallocated or unclaimed funds.
- GitLab will only pay for the claim amount approved, not fees for wire transfer deposit or local currency deposit.
- Lead lists provided as POP will not be used by GitLab's Sales team to call or nurture without written permission from the partner, or unless the customer has already engaged directly with GitLab.
- You must conduct your business and marketing operations in an ethical manner and in accordance with all applicable United States and international laws, ordinances, codes, and regulations. You may not directly or indirectly make, authorize, offer, or promise to make or give any money, bribe, gift, or anything of value to any person for the purposes of influencing that person or a family member of that person under circumstances where the payment or gift would constitute an illegal payment under the laws of the U.S. or any country.
- All decisions related to program benefits and eligibility are at the sole discretion of GitLab.
- Partners eligible for MDF must be a GitLab Channel Partner in good standing, with a valid and current Channel Partner Agreement. Upon termination or expiration of the Channel Agreement, all in-progress MDFs (even if MDF approval has been given) will be forfeited.
- Submission of false or fraudulent claims can cause you to be ineligible for the MDF Program and may render MDF requests to be forfeited, regardless of their stage of execution.
- You may not deduct or set off an MDF claim from any payment due to GitLab in the regular course of business with GitLab.
- GitLab reserves the right to audit and verify all MDF claims and request additional documentation at any time. GitLab may deny any MDF claims that it believes, at its sole and absolute discretion, do not conform to these guidelines.
- If GitLab subsequently denies an MDF claim for good cause after reimbursement, you must immediately return such funding to GitLab.
- The terms of these MDF guidelines are in addition to the applicable Channel Partner Agreement in place with GitLab; they are valid only when specifically referenced from the applicable Channel Partner Agreement, program guide, or otherwise made available to a channel party by GitLab in writing. All terms not otherwise defined herein have the meaning set forth in the applicable Channel Partner Agreement.
- You are authorized to use GitLab's names, marks, logos, and other identifiers as approved in advance in writing, on or in connection with your own marketing and promotion of GitLab products and services. Your use of GitLab logos needs to be solely in accordance with the GitLab Partner Program Agreement and any additional trademark guidelines GitLab provides.
- It is understood that when MDF are used to fund an event participation where a show booth is part of your event presence, that no branding of a competing vendor is to be used alongside GitLab's brand on that booth.

GitLab's internal MDF Process Workflow

Phase 1: Pre-planning

- Budget is established by the year, allocated by each quarter, then region, and should be planned in a 6 month cycle.
- Channel Marketing Managers work on creating a strategic marketing plan on a 6 month rolling calendar.

- Internal approvals are needed. Plans are reviewed by Channel Marketing Manager's Team Managers and MDF Program Owner.
- If an MDF activity requires a contract signed or has a specific contract for that particular event, such as sponsorships or conferences, contracts need to be reviewed and approved by Legal before the approval is communicated to the Partner.
 - In this case, CMMs are to submit contract to the MDF Program Owner and they will open a Zip request to get approval done.
- Once internal approvals have been completed, CMMs communicate to Partners activities that are approved.
- If the MDF activity is a sponsorship and it does not have a specific contract from the partner legal will create one once communicated to them within the Zip approval process. This will then follow the same legal process as listed above.
- Partners are responsible for submitting an MDF request through the Partner Portal.

Phase 2: Processing MDF

When a MDF fund request is received, the Channel Marketing Manager receives an email alert to approve the MDF request.

<!-- At this point, all the MDFs that were approved and are ready to be processed.-->

Processing an MDF consists of:

- Adding the MDF in Salesforce, with all of its information.
- We don't add this in the pre-planning phase because sometimes fund requests may get canceled or the Marketing Activity/event moves to a different date.
- From Allocadia we opens issue for the MDF request.
 - Marketo and Salesforce Campaign are created.

<!-- POP Tracking board:

To better track the POP we have created a MDF Operations Board.

- POP Label description can be found in this section of the handbook. -->
- Channel Marketing Managers are also tagged to create their own activity tracking issue.
- A Zip requisition request is opened.
- Zip will now have an MDF approver (MDF Program Owner) to make sure we have all of the correct information updated and to make sure that payment is not process for partner before receiving the POP.
- After that Zip approval will take 4 business days.

Phase 3: Payment

- Three automated emails are sent to partners notifying them to submit their claims.
- Email 1: sent a day after the activity end date
- Email 2: 14-day after the activity end date has passed
- Email 3: 28 days after the activity end date has passed, alerting them once the 30-day deadline has been reached, GitLab can contractually decline to pay if the MDF Claim is not submitted. For new partners that need to be onboarded in Coupa we are allowing a 35 day deadline.
- A communication will be made to the Channel Marketing Managers if claim has not yet been made and Channel Marketing Managers will reach out to Partners.

Once a claim is submitted MDF Program Owner receives an automated email.

- All of the files received by the partner are checked. If any documentation is missing or does not fulfill the MDF Guidelines we will reach out to partner.
- All of the documentation gets uploaded to the POP issue and the label for MDF Program Owner to review and approve.
- MDF Program Owner checks every POP issue, looking at lead list, invoice and supporting images/pdfs and approves it or tags Channel Marketing Managers if there's a concern.
- Once approved, Teri will upload the lead list to the Lead Upload Issue.
- She will email the invoice to AP.
- She will note in Zip/Coupa - MDF Reimbursement payment is clear to pay.
- Payment can take up to 45 days once invoice is submitted to Accounts Payable.

Canceling MDF Activities

Channel Marketing Manager Tasks

- CMM to update Allocadia showing the MDF activity as canceled by going to the mdf sub-category panel and selecting Yes to the Campaign Canceled? dropdown. CMM to also add in CANCELED to the event sub-category title and to the Official Event/Campaign Name field so the title in the main issue stays updated.
- CMM to remove any planned/forecasted costs in Allocadia accordingly.
- CMM to ping the Channel Marketing Programs Manager (CMPM) and staff/DRI's in the main MDF epic to communicate the cancellation and close out the issue.

Channel Marketing Programs Manager Tasks

- The CMPM will comment regarding the cancellation in all open sub-issues and close out the issues.
- If applicable, CMPM to delete the Zip req and comment that the MDF has been canceled.
- If applicable, CMPM to ping procurement and finance in the Coupa req to notify them that the MDF has been canceled.
- Once all sub-issues are closed, the CMPM will also note the cancellation in the epic and close the epic.
- The CMPM will change the MDF Request status in SFDC from Approved to Cancelled or denied (where applicable) if request has been submitted by the partner. By doing so the Partner will receive an automated email informing the Funds Request initially submitted has been cancelled or denied.
- SFDC: CMPM to add [CANCELED] to the campaign name and select Aborted in the Campaign Status dropdown. Also, unlink the Partner Account and un-sync to Vartopia.
- Marketo: CMPM to delete Marketo program.

<!-- FY25 Q2 GitLab Biz Development team to prospect leads from MDF Campaigns

- Exciting offering for our partners who are running MDF campaigns with us in FY25 Q2 (May 1, 2024 - July 31, 2024).
- At the partners election, GitLab's in-house prospecting experts(the GitLab BDR team) will work on your behalf to surface joint opportunities from agreed MDF campaigns, allowing you and your teams to focus on the deal progression and beyond.
- Even though the GitLab BDR team will be working to surface the opportunity for you, you will

still be entitled to your pricing and discounts as listed in the partner portal.

The fine print

1. The GitLab BDR team will only work the leads from qualified MDF campaigns based on the following criteria:

1. Leads which have scored enough points to be considered a GitLab marketing qualified lead (MQL).

1. Are from an actively working account - regardless of how many points they have gathered [and/or] are from a group of accounts called Actively Working Accounts which is a set of accounts the BDR team has a specific outbound prospecting strategy for.

1. The GitLab BDR team will inform you on the records we have worked & send back to you the leads which did not meet the above criteria for your own nurturing.

1. For more information on the MDF program, please see the MDF Program Introduction information found in the partner portal.-->

Contact us

For more information on marketing development funds, please email us at partner-marketing@gitlab.com

SECTION: resellers/channel-working-with-gitlab/index.md

GitLab Channel Partners are the primary audience for this handbook page.

Working with GitLab Introduction for Partners

In this section you will be given a deep dive into working with and managing the Five Main aspects of the GitLab: (1) Working with GitLab - Administration, (2) Working with GitLab - Sales, (3) Working with GitLab - Marketing, (4) Working with GitLab - Technical, and (5) Working with GitLab - Distributors.

Working with GitLab - Administration

Partner Registration: Getting Started with GitLab

To get started with GitLab, register your company by going to <https://partners.gitlab.com>. The system will prompt you for your company and personal contact information, as well as your personal contact information. A GitLab Channel Account Manager may contact you for qualification. If you agree to proceed, your company will be required to sign a GitLab Reseller Agreement. Once you are registered, you can:

- Work with your GitLab Channel Account Manager or distributor to begin business and sales planning.
- Visit the portal and encourage your colleagues to sign up at <https://partners.gitlab.com>.
- Complete the onboarding tasks that will help you familiarize yourself with available GitLab resources.
- Take the sales training as well as other relevant training.

- Register your first deal.

Creating Partner Portal Logins for Users (After Partner Registration)

This information can also be found in the Partner Guide(portal login required to access)). \ If a partner organization already exists in the partner portal, but a new partner user needs login credentials:

- Visit our partner portal
- Select "Register" in the top right corner

The partner user will be directed to a page that asks them to confirm the organization they work for. After they confirm, they should click next, and fill in their information. After submitting the information, they'll receive login credentials if it is an active partner account with GitLab. Email partnersupport@gitlab.com if you have any problems.

Completing Training and Certifications

Our training programs are available primarily through the GitLab Partner Portal. There, you will find the accreditation courses and testing needed to meet your GitLab program requirements for sales, pre-sales, technical, and professional services training. Check out the Channel Partner Training and Certifications handbook page for additional information.

Please review the different Accreditation requirements for Open Partner and Select Partner tracks.

Remitting payment to GitLab

You can arrange for payment either via invoice, or your customer can pay us directly.

By Purchase Order

If your customer will be paying us via a Purchase Order, then you must email us a copy so that we may invoice the customer. Please send the Purchase Order to POfulfillment@gitlab.com for fulfillment.

Paying via Invoice

To pay via invoice, simply e-sign the reseller quote to initiate an invoice, then remit payment in USD to the bank listed on your quote.

Channel Resources and Tools

We want to help our Partners succeed. We have created marketing resources and tools for our Partner to use to help grow their GitLab business. See the Channel Tools and Resources handbook page to learn more.

Or you can get started today by going to the Partner Portal.

Working with GitLab - Sales

Discounts and Referral Fees

The GitLab Partner Program helps develop your practice to best fit your business model. You can earn one-time and recurring revenues from product and services sales, referrals, and services delivery and resale.

To view the GitLab Partner Program Discount and Referral Fee Table, please visit the GitLab Partner Portal (must be an authorized Partner) and access the Incentive Guide in the Program Documents folder in the Asset Library.

Authorized Public Sector Partners can earn one-time and recurring revenues from product and services sales, referrals, and services delivery and resale. To view Public Sector discounts, please visit the GitLab Partner Portal (must be an authorized Public Sector Partner) and access the Incentive Guide in the Program Documents folder in the Asset Library. GitLab employees can access the discount table [here](#) and the Public Sector table [here](#).

NOTE: Discounts are off list price. If GitLab is deeply discounting a large annual recurring revenue (ARR) customer engagement, the Partner can reasonably expect to share in that with a discount reduction. The Partner, GitLab sales, and Channel Account Manager must agree on the negotiated discount amount.

Deal Registration Program Overview

To promote the growth and success of GitLab channels, manage channel conflict, and provide a systematic approach to pursuing sales opportunities, GitLab has formalized the rules of engagement and deal registration procedures. Since the first qualified deal registration requires approval, Partners are encouraged to submit their deal registrations as early as possible to lock in the biggest discount. Partners in the GitLab Partner Program need to register individual sales opportunities; Partners may not register an account or combine opportunities. Review the Definitions and Qualifications section of this page for more detail on what GitLab defines as Partner Sourced and Co-sell deal registrations.

- Deal registration approval is based upon order of receipt of the registration, qualification of the opportunity, Partner ability to deliver in-country/region support, and Partner relationship with the customer. Deal registration approval is required and will be made by GitLab's Sales team.
- Only one Partner can earn a deal registration discount per opportunity. Partners, other than the Partner granted the deal registration discount that requests a quote, will receive the co-sell discount rate.
- New or existing customer opportunities or new opportunities with existing customers can qualify for deal registration discounts. Add-on sales to renewals can also qualify.
- Approved deal registrations have a standard 90-day expiration from the date of original approval. (Deal Registration extensions beyond the initial 90 days approval are at the sole discretion of GitLab.) GitLab collaborates with Partners holding the approved deal registration and is available to support Partners throughout the entire sales process.
- In the event the engagement is dissolved, the GitLab Sales Rep will generally notify you by phone or email. GitLab will reconsider other deal registrations submitted for this deal, in chronological order of submission. If there are no other registration requests submitted, the GitLab Sales Rep will typically initiate engagement with a reseller of the GitLab Sales Rep's choosing.

Only authorized Partners that have signed the GitLab Partner Program Agreement are able to register deals, earn program discounts, and transact with GitLab. Unauthorized Partners do not qualify. Additionally, at least one of the Partner's employees must complete the GitLab Foundations for Partners training for the Partner to qualify for deal registration and program discounts.

Deal Registration Instructions

Our Deal Registration process allows us to incentivize our Partners to source and close GitLab products and services opportunities and avoid channel conflict. You can find an overview of the Deal Registration Program, including rules of engagement, [here](#). The following section provides instructions for this process.

Submitting a Deal Registration

1. Go to the GitLab Partner Portal and select "Deals" in the menu".
2. Choose to "Add a Registration."
3. Choose "GitLab" under the list of vendors.
4. When asked to select a program, choose either "Deal Registration" for a standard licensing sale ("Referral," "Resale," or "MSP") or "Service Attached Registration" if you're submitting a registration to participate in our rebate program for services that you're providing to the customer.
5. Complete and ensure all information has been filled out. GitLab will not engage based on a speculative or poorly defined opportunity or with a reseller that is not eligible to win a sales opportunity.
6. Choose "Submit the deal."
7. Go through the review and approval process.

Once deal registrations are received, a GitLab Sales Rep will:

- Review the deal registration application.
- Advise if you are the first to register an opportunity.
- Work with you to confirm whether a deal is a qualified sales opportunity.

How Licensing Registrations Work

- Only a properly completed deal registration submission can initiate an engagement and, as mentioned, engagements are not exclusive. Thus, it is in all parties' best interest to complete a deal registration form as soon as a qualified sales opportunity is identified.
- The GitLab Sales Rep checks to see if GitLab is already engaged with another reseller on this opportunity. If so, the Sales Rep rejects the deal registration and notifies you that GitLab cannot engage with you.
- If GitLab is not already engaged with another reseller, the Sales Rep or Account Executive contacts you to schedule a meeting or conference call with the customer to confirm that the following requirements are met:
 - The information submitted on the deal registration form is complete and correct.
 - A qualified sales opportunity exists.
 - You are in full compliance with an appropriate and effective GitLab Reseller Agreement and all applicable policies/programs.
 - The customer has not selected an alternate GitLab reseller for this deal.

- The customer agrees that you are eligible to win this business.

Note: "Eligible" means that you meet all contractual or regulatory requirements to bid on the deal and that the customer is willing to buy you. This is particularly relevant with government contracts or bids, but could also apply to commercial work.

If any of the above requirements are not met or you fail to promptly schedule a meeting or conference call with the customer, the GitLab Sales Rep may advise you that GitLab cannot engage with you for this opportunity. GitLab will then reconsider other deal registration applications submitted for this deal in order of submission. You may subsequently attempt to remedy this situation and submit another deal registration form for this deal, but this will be considered a new submission.

How Service Attached Registrations Work

The Service Attached incentive is based on the volume of licensing opportunities with services attached to those licensing deals. The more licensing deals you attach services to, the richer the program becomes.

The partner must submit service opportunities via a Service Attached Registration on the Partner Portal. Service Attached qualifications do not require license purchases through the services partner. Customers can obtain licenses directly from GitLab, through a services partner, or from other partners.

Select partners and/or PSPs with approved Service Attached Registrations qualify for quarterly back-end rebates. This is separate from the Partner Sourced Deal Registration for the license sale. In addition, approved and accepted Service Attached Registrations count towards partners' PSP qualifications.

Service Attached Registrations are submitted via the Partner Portal as a deal registration (Deal Registration Type = Services Attach) and then linked to a software license sale opportunity.

- Service must be connected to a GitLab software opportunity sold to an end customer directly by GitLab, via reseller, or via a cloud marketplace
- MSP software opportunities where licenses are sold to and owned by the partner do not qualify for Service Attached Registration
- Each closed-won software opportunity can only have one approved Service Attached Registration (i.e., one software opportunity to one registration)

Qualification Categories

Approved - Qualifies for Rebate and PSP

The following criteria must be met for a Service Attached Registration to be approved and for a partner to receive a rebate:

- Completion of the associated software opportunity (i.e., closed-won)
- Partner must be Select and/or PSP
- Partner must submit a fully executed Statement of Work (SOW) to partnersupport@gitlab.com and

include the Deal ID number. Partner may alternatively provide written customer acknowledgement of completed work descriptions for customers in regulated industries (e.g., Public Sector), provided all criteria noted below are met

- The SOW must:
 - verify that the services meet both program guidelines and customer needs as outlined in the current program guidance (found in the Partner Portal) for incentive
 - confirm the dates of the project and include customer signatures
 - be signed and submitted within 6 months after opportunity closure
 - Note: If the SOW is unable to be signed, it can be considered with an accompanying proof of execution, such as a PO, signed order form, or customer email confirmation of the service engagement
 - be dated (i.e., customer signature) within 6 months of submission
- Each SOW can only be applied to one Service Attached Registration (i.e., one SOW cannot be used for multiple registrations). However, exceptions may be considered on a case-by-case basis for multi-phase projects that drive an add-on or upsell opportunity.
- Scope of services
 - In Scope: Implementation, Integration, Optimization, Migration, Managed/hosted services (with software sold to / owned by end customer), Security/Compliance, Adoption, Assessment, Transformation, Application Development, DevSecOps AI, Support and/or Success Services
 - Out of Scope: Education/Training, Subcontracted services, Free-of-charge services, Managed/hosted services (with software sold to / owned by the partner)

Rebates for approved Service Attached Registrations are paid out no later than 45 days after the end of each quarter. To view the GitLab Service Attached Incentive Program, please visit the GitLab Partner Portal and access the resources in the Program Documents folder in the Asset Library.

Service Attached Registrations that do not qualify for approval for the rebate per the terms noted above will still be considered for PSP Delivery Requirements per the Qualification Category - Accepted.

Accepted - Qualifies for PSP

- Paid service engagement with a SOW signed and submitted within 12 months of registration submission and closed-won Net ARR opportunity
- Free of charge, partner-led services that show proof of execution, such as assessments
- Closed-won managed/hosted service deal registrations (with software sold to / owned by the partner)

Unqualified - Does not qualify for Rebate or PSP

- Services that are not directly related to GitLab
- Engagements without a related license opportunity in Salesforce
- Services for GitLab CE customers without a pending upgrade opportunity
- GitLab PS subcontracting engagements
- Education/Training services

Returned

- Returned to the partner for more information

Quote to Order

Authorized partners who have achieved at least Open Status may request a quote and transact with GitLab.

GitLab quotes reflect reseller pricing, exclusive of incentive rebates, and any discounts provided are not meant for the end customer to see. Resellers need to generate their own quote to the end customer and can then provide any customer discount at that time.

GitLab quotes may come with a Sertifi link. E-signing the quote with Sertifi initiates the invoicing process and causes our systems to invoice you. Do not e-sign the quote until you are ready to be invoiced. Do not e-sign the quote if your customer will be paying us directly.

GitLab will not generate a quote, or fulfill an order, without an end user contact complete with email, shipping address, and postal code.

Receive a GitLab Reseller Quote

Select Partners and partners in areas where there is no active distributor must purchase directly through GitLab. To receive a quote, partners can either register a deal or reach out to their channel manager and request a quote. The channel manager will connect the partner with the appropriate sales team who will work with the partner throughout the life of the opportunity.

To submit a purchase order for a resell-direct opportunity, please submit your PO to the sales team you have been working with for the opportunity.

Receive a GitLab Reseller Quote via Distributor

Open Partners are required to purchase through a distribution partner in every territory with an active distributor. All quote requests and purchase orders can be sent directly to the distributor.

- In EMEA: Partners transact with Amazic via gitlab@amazic.com.
- In Japan: Partners transact with Networkld
- In APAC (several countries but excluding Japan): Partners transact with Tech Data/TD Synnex
 - In India: Partners may also choose to transact with Redington via gitlab@redington.co.in.
- US PubSec: Partners transact with Carahsoft via gitlab@carahsoft.com

License Key Delivery

Once the order is invoiced and the customer accepts the EULA (see below), they are able to activate their GitLab license key. The invoice contact of the transacting partner (either distributor or reseller) is copied on this email.

Customer Support, Subscription Changes and Email Updates

When customers have technical support needs or need to make changes to a subscription, partners should submit a support ticket on behalf of the customer. For detailed instructions on how to submit a support ticket, including a step-by-step guide with screenshots, please see the

Partner Guide located in the Partner Portal.

Subscription email address changes, other subscription changes, license resends, and technical problems are all handled through the technical support ticket process.

To submit a Support Ticket, navigate to the "Technical Readiness" page in the partner portal and select the appropriate Submit a Support Ticket link. Please ensure you follow all listed instructions and read the recommended handbook pages to ensure a prompt response from the Technical Support team. The Partner Support team is unable to assist with Technical Support needs.

Execute the GitLab EULA

All orders require an executed EULA when there's a new subscription or an add-on. There are 2 methods of obtaining a EULA:

1. License Key Deployment: The default for reseller orders is that the end customer will receive a link to download their license key. The customer needs to click an acceptance of terms to get their key.
2. Physical Signature: Some customers may require a fully countersigned document.

An order is not complete without a signed agreement.

Evaluation Licenses for Prospects

- We will issue a 30-day evaluation license for your prospects if the deal is properly registered.
- We can renew this license if your customer needs more time.
- Upon the second request for renewal (the third license), we assist you with a managed evaluation, where goals are set for the customer to meet. One of our Solutions Architects works with you and the prospect to bring them to completion before the third evaluation expires.

Definitions and Qualifications

- Partner-Sourced Discount
 - Partners can earn the largest available product discount with a Partner-sourced opportunity. This opportunity is a new opportunity for the GitLab Sales team, and is available to new or existing customers.
 - The Partner-sourced discount is an upfront discount. The Partner is expected to assist the GitLab Sales team in closing the sale. To qualify for this discount, Partners must submit a deal registration to GitLab via the GitLab Partner Portal, and it must be approved by GitLab Sales to qualify. A Partner-sourced discount is available for both resale and referral opportunities.
 - Partners purchasing GitLab for their own internal production use and add-on licenses at renewal can also qualify for a partner-sourced discount; however, they must first meet all program requirements for their specific program track (Open or Select). Please visit the Deal Registration Program guideline in the Program Guide for additional details.
- Partner Co-Sell Opportunity · Partners can earn a discount for a GitLab-sourced opportunity where the Partner assists the GitLab Sales team in closing and/or transacting the deal. This may include demonstrating GitLab software, organizing executive meetings, supporting contract

negotiations, delivering services, fulfillment, etc. It is an upfront discount. To qualify for the Partner-assist discount, GitLab Sales team members will attach a Partner to an opportunity, but Partners do not need to submit a deal registration.

- First Order Incentive · Partners can receive an incentive paid as a rebate for partner-sou